

COMMUNITY LIFE

GOOD NEWS FILE

First bus ride for young students

Again this summer, the local school boards are joining forces with McCreary Bus Lines to help take the worry out of that first school bus ride for youngsters heading into kindergarten this fall.

The "First Ride Bus Safety Program" is open to all first-time Comba, St. Mary's, Naismith and Pakenham JK and SK students and their parents. The objective is to promote school bus safety for the youngest members of the communities as well as provide an enjoyable afternoon for parents and child.

The program schedule includes the following events:

- program registration,
- "Winnie the Pooh" school bus safety video,
- school bus ride for parents and children...discussion of safety rules and practice loading and unloading school bus,
- stationary buses for parents and children to walk through,
- safety certificates, literature, pamphlets, and colouring/activity books,
- refreshments.

In Almonte, the program will be run from Naismith school Sunday, Aug. 17 with registration starting at 1 p.m. Parents and students can expect to spend approximately one hour at the afternoon's activities.

Burgess makes Dean's list

Chris Burgess, whose long and triple jump accomplishments have earned him NCAA all-American status the past two years, has shown again that he might be judged all-world in the classroom as well.

St. Lawrence University announced last week that the former Almonte and District High School graduate had been named to the Dean's List again for 1997. The Pakenham native graduated from the Canton, N.Y., school this spring with a Bachelor of Science degree (Major in Sport and Leisure studies).

To be eligible for the Dean's List, a student must have completed at least four semester units and have an academic average of 3.6 (based on a perfect 4.0 scale) for the semester.

Outdoor court ready for action

The outdoor asphalt basketball court at the Naismith Visitors' Centre is open and waiting for action.

Jean Gosset of the Naismith Foundation said last week that some area residents have already been out to the Ramsay Township site to test the facility. The court has two mobile baskets located at each end of the court and basketballs are readily available for use by whoever comes out. Permanent hoops will be installed later this summer.

Call the centre at 256-0492 for more information.

Have some good news to share? Why not drop us a note or give us a call at 256-2167.



HAPPY 16th
CHRIS
LOVE — DAD
and MOM



HAPPY
BIRTHDAY
SWEET 16
LOVE — MOM and
DAD, HEATHER,
DAVID and PHIL



Rayguard says:
SLIP on a shirt,
SLAP on a hat,
SLOP on some sunscreen.



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Diefenbunker to become home to Canadian Cold War Museum

By Debora Dekok
Gazette Reporter

CARP - History will soon be made here when the Diefenbunker opens as Canada's First Cold War Museum.

According to the Historic Sites and Monuments Board of Canada, the structure is "the most important surviving Cold War site in Canada."

The bunker, located in Carp, was designed to house 300 people, mostly government officials and top military brass, in the event of a nuclear holocaust.

Nine West Carleton residents met in January to see how the bunker could be preserved, and from that meeting, the Diefenbunker Development Group was formed.

"We have a vision...to create a Canadian Cold War Museum. And that's what we're all about," said Dr. Barry Bruce, head of the group.

"This was the key federal emergency site," said Andy Renault, former Acting Director of Operations with Emergency Preparedness Canada and member of the Diefenbunker Development Group.

Originally described as an army signals establishment by the government, it was dubbed "the Diefenbunker" by the media when it's real purpose was found out. John Diefenbaker was the Prime Minister at the time.

The four-story deep shelter was built in 1961. Encased in five feet of gravel, the bunker was designed to withstand a small nuclear bomb's direct hit. There was computer equipment to keep officials in touch with others holed up in five smaller bunkers across Canada, as well as a CBC radio to send out radio messages to any survivors.



Pierre Robillard pushes the thick steel door of the Bank of Canada vault in the Diefenbunker. Robillard, now a tour guide for the bunker, stayed there for five days in 1962 during the tense Cuban Missile Crisis as a civil employee with the Canadian Corps of Engineers.

The equipment was mounted on huge springs to absorb the shock of a nuclear blast.

The Diefenbunker has bedrooms and offices for the prime minister and governor-general, a hospital, a morgue, a jail, and a huge vault where Canada's money could be kept. Garbage from the cafeteria would be compacted and frozen. Sewage would be piped out while fresh water would be piped in and huge filters would clean air before bringing it into the shelter.

Constructed on an 85 acre site, it cost about \$300 million in today's dollars. The federal government sold it to the West Carleton Township for \$235,000 in 1994, but not before stripping it of all its furniture.

Now the Diefenbunker Development Group is looking to refurbish the bunker.

"We're trying to re-create key rooms, like the cabinet room, the Prime Minister's

suite, the kitchen and dining area. (We're looking for) tables, chairs, computer equipment, and equipment from the broadcast centre," said Katherine Hollingsworth, public relations director for the group.

"DND removed it. We don't know where it went." Some of the furniture was redistributed among Canada's military bases, but many of the artifacts were taken by personnel for souvenirs when the bunker closed.

Some are now realizing they are in possession of a piece of history that belongs to all Canadians.

"People are calling us and saying, 'Listen, I took this to save. They're calling us and giving it back,'" Hollingsworth said.

Volunteer tour guide Dixie Trenholm pointed out, "In a lot of people's minds, that's not history if we can remember it."

The museum will not only remember the Diefenbunker, but also memories

of the threat of nuclear war.

"We're not just going to do tours," explained Dr. Bruce. "The museum will tell the story of the Cold War. We'll bring in government pamphlets on how to build bomb shelters and information on the Cuban Missile Crisis, the Avro Arrow construction, and the Bomarc missile will all be a part of the Cold War Museum."

"The whole world was involved in it. It involved such extreme danger. This is the closest the human race ever came to complete destruction."

The group is targeting next year for the museum's official opening.

"We hope to open the middle of June '98," predicted Dr. Bruce.

The Diefenbunker will be open for tours this summer from July 18 to Aug. 4, after which group tours will be available by appointment. Tours can be booked by calling 839-5280.

MVFN make excursion to Bluebird Acres

Watch out for that Osprey! They came so close we could see the sun-fish the male was taking to the nest. Throughout the morning we heard their high pitched squeal-like calls. Another highlight was the Hummingbird Garden where, among red flowering plants and feeders, male hummers flashed their ruby neck

patches to one another and to the duller-plumaged females. The ruby throat really does glow.

Fifteen members and guests of the Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists (MVFN) aged from two and one-half months to over 70 years toured Bluebird Acres with Art Briggs-Jude, the owner. Art and his wife Wendy are

remarkable people who are creating a plant, fish and wildlife haven from an old 300 acre farm. They are six miles north of Westport on County Road 36.

Art was an air gunner in the Hitler war, made his career in pulp and paper, and is now a leading land steward. He is also most friendly, and an excellent teacher. Anyone who

wants to see wildlife, or manage their gardens or acreage to attract wildlife, can learn much from what is done by Art and Wendy.

At a slow walk (ride if you wish) we ambled through or by forest, field, marsh, stream and pond. We saw or heard perhaps 20 species of birds and six species of mammals.

MIXED STAG

for TRACY HOLMES and RON BRYDGES

Saturday, July 26, 1997

ALMONTE CIVITAN HALL

8:00 p.m. to 1:00 a.m.

TICKETS — \$5.00

MS
FACT
#1

Canada has one of the highest rates of multiple sclerosis in the world.

Multiple Sclerosis

Society of Canada

1-800-268-7582

A "40" BEAR STORY



The oldest Bear is just over 40,
The next Bear soon to be 40,
The twin Bears getting closer to 40.

LOVE — THE LITTLE BEAR
WHO IS NO WHERE NEAR 40!

MIXED PARTY

SCHLIEVERT & McKAY

in honour of SHAYELYNNE and CHRIS

to be held at ALMONTE CIVITAN CLUB

JULY 18, 1997

8:00 p.m. - 1:00 a.m.

\$3.00 each or 2 for \$5.00

TICKETS AVAILABLE AT THE DOOR



BAIRD - THOMPSON

Dwain and Norma Baird are pleased to announce the engagement of their daughter, Stacie Leigh to Bradley Michael, son of Ms. Donna M. A. Metcalfe and Michael and Nancy Thompson. The wedding will take place on August 9, 1997, at St. James Church in Carp, Ontario.

3rd ANNUAL FUNDRAISER DANCE

PAKENHAM COMMUNITY CENTRE
SATURDAY, JULY 26 — 8 p.m. - 1 a.m.

Music by: WILDRIDE, BIG PICTURE,
RON and JAMIE McMUNN, MIKE RYAN and
DAVEY DRUMMOND — MC MAX KEEPING
Tickets — \$8.00 — available at Byrne Home Hardware
or call 624-5371 or 5502
ALL PROCEEDS TO THE BRAIN TUMOR FOUNDATION

THANK YOU

To all my friends and family for helping me celebrate my 87th Birthday on July 5th at the Almonte United Church, with your presence, cards and gifts.

A SPECIAL THANK YOU to the Fireside Group for the lovely lunch.

Willow Julian



ALMONTE/RAMSAY
FIRE
DEPARTMENT

is pleased to announce our

30th ANNIVERSARY of the PANCAKE BREAKFAST

JULY 18

7:00 p.m. — STREET DANCE

NO ADMISSION — TOWN HALL LOT

10:30 p.m. — FIREWORKS

JULY 19

7:00 a.m. - 11:00 a.m. —

PANCAKE BREAKFAST

ADMISSION — \$4.00/Person — Special Family Rate

\$1.00 OFF for Pajamas Attire

COME CELEBRATE

10:00 a.m. — PANORAMIC GROUP PHOTO



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CLIP FOR REFERENCE

IN MEMORIAL 1997 SERVICES

(LOCAL CEMETERIES)

AULD KIRK CEMETERY (Almonte)

Sunday, August 17th at 2:00 p.m.

ST. MARY'S PARISH CEMETERY (Almonte)

Saturday, August 16th at 10:00 a.m.

(In case of rain, St. Mary's Church)

ST. MICHAEL'S PARISH CEMETERY (Corkery)

Sunday, July 20th at 1:00 p.m.

(In case of rain, St. Michael's Church)

INDIAN HILL CEMETERY (Pakenham)

Sunday, August 31st at 3:00 p.m.

(In case of rain, St. Peter's Celestine Church)

UNION CEMETERY (Pakenham)

Sunday, August 10th at 2:00 p.m.

(In case of rain, St. Andrew's United Church)

CLAYTON UNITED CHURCH CEMETERY (Clayton)

Sunday, August 10th at 3:00 p.m.

ST. GEORGE'S ANGLICAN CEMETERY (Clayton)

Sunday, August 3rd at 2:30 p.m.

(In case of rain, St. George's Church)

GREENWOOD CEMETERY (Middleville)

Sunday, July 20th at 3:00 p.m.

CEDAR HILL CEMETERY (Cedar Hill)

Sunday, September 21st, at 11:00 a.m.

In Zion United Church, Cedar Hill

C. R. GAMBLE FUNERAL
HOME & CHAPEL

and
REG GAMBLE representing

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MONUMENTS — 256-3313